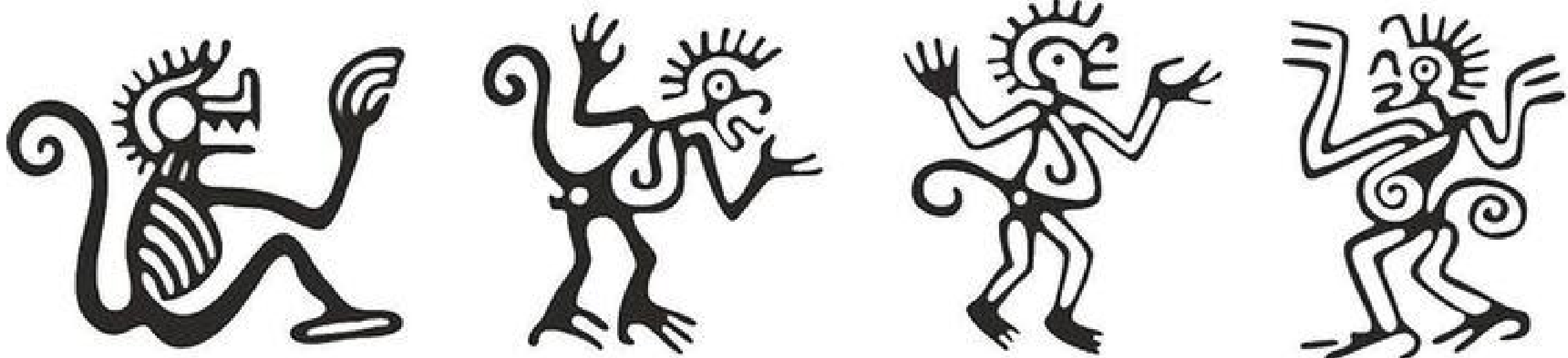


Top Team Alignment or Top Team Development



Top team alignment methodologies can be used when there is a change in strategy/systems and general aspiration for the future. The advantage is that, this can be done quickly. A contractual alignment is possible, though the lack of intent level and belief level alignment might create passive aggression and reduce the speed of execution.

Top team development can be used as a positive methodology to bring about deep personal connect among members, alignment of aspirations and ideas, drive execution and build a productive culture.

Need

While most organisations have a strategy to develop their talent; the top team development usually becomes a blind spot and takes a back seat. Top teams usually have high levels of responsibility, ambiguity, and accountability and pressure. So focusing on serious and collective Top Team Development often becomes a luxury and not a necessity!

Although top teams actively engage in talent development for others in the organisation, reflecting on the efficiency of their own leadership occurs only occasionally through some surveys. And then these surveys throw up some insights about the top team effectiveness. They usually spend a day to discuss this and take actions. When we compare this to the developmental inputs that a middle level executive or a high potential talent receives in an organisation, we understand that this is negligible.

Top leadership team is very clear about What the organisation trying to achieve, the goals and how they are going to go about it, the strategy. But who are we being while we are doing these things is the blind spot. Ron Heifetz, a professor at Harvard University and author of Leadership Without Easy Answers (1998), makes the point that leaders periodically need to get off the dance floor and get up on the balcony. By doing so, you can see the patterns and the flow of your employees working better than when they are right in front of you. Heifetz believes that leaders need to regularly “get up in the balcony” and get a different perspective of everything that is going on.

When it comes to learning interventions for top team usually some of them are sent to a management institute of repute or just given a coach. But both these approaches fail to address the collective capability building and culture building in the top team.

Our Approach

In our experience of working with top teams, we found that a top team intervention should focus on these three themes.

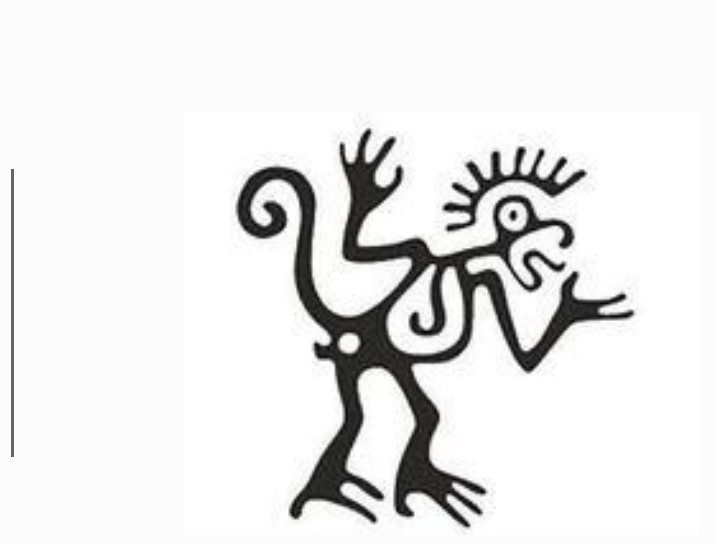


1. Personal effectiveness

Improving the personal effectiveness and leadership competency of executive team members. Here we focus on the Self and address Authenticity—Individual congruence of thought, speech and action. Driving organization transformation and culture require leaders to look into themselves, take feedback from other stakeholders and willingness to change.

2. Improving Alignment

Working effectively as a group. The focus is to overcome different agendas and increase collaboration. Members of a top team are typically successful in their own function but often far from forming a collective agenda to openly and collaboratively address their challenges. Here we address both behavioural and systemic aspect of silos and collaboration.





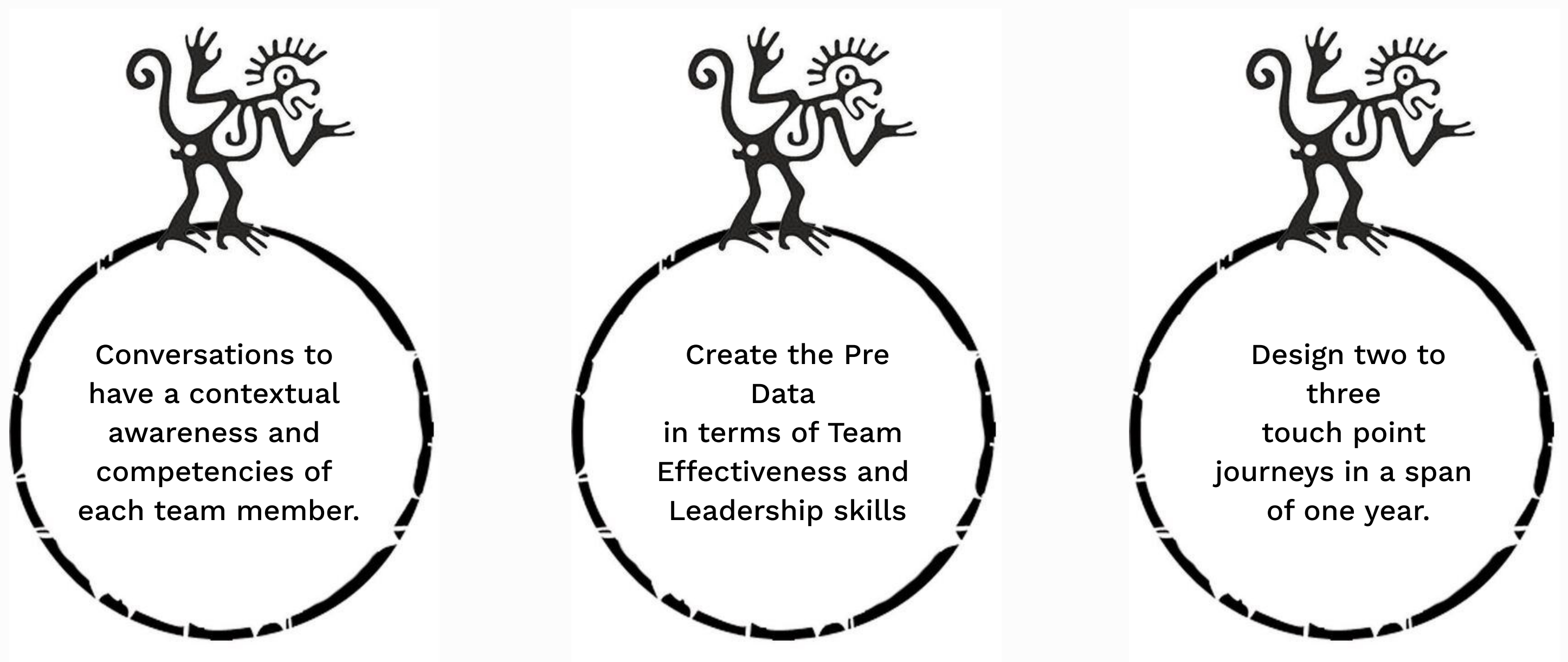
3. Ability to create new possibilities and action.

Improving the personal effectiveness and leadership competency of executive team members. Here we focus on the Self and address Authenticity—Individual congruence of thought, speech and action. Driving organization transformation and culture require leaders to look into themselves, take feedback from other stakeholders and willingness to change.

ODA Expertise

- We have done Top team Development journeys for Wells Fargo Abbott, Maruti , Lafarge, Sterlite, GSK consumer, Novartis, MSD, NIIT, Mercedes Benz, IDFC, Ranbaxy, Max Group etc. All these interventions were with CEO and his leadership team or extended leadership team. We have done Top Team Alignment workshops with Britannia, Wells Fargo, Subex, KPMG, Novartis, ASK, Axis Bank, Kotak Bank, Manipal Hospitals, Ashok Leyland etc.
- Our pool of executive coaches who have been CXOs, have helped in this journey when one on one coaching was used.
- We have been able to in past to link these interventions to organisational goals and priorities so they become relevant and contextual.

1. Scope of work for Top Team Development



Suggested design for the journey

- The first module to look at Self- Leadership Styles, values and personal aspirations and legacy that each one wants to leave behind for the organisation. Alignment on overall aspiration of the organisation and strategies.
- The second module focuses on building their teams, coaching effectively and building a positive productive culture.
- The third module focuses on System Thinking/ Managing complexity and driving results.
- Do a post data collection to see how and where we have moved.
- If we decide, we could provide coaches to all participants for six months.

2. Scope of work for Top Team Development

- Diagnosis interviews and data collection on Team Effectiveness, Team norms and behaviors and trust among team members.
- Presenting the data to key leaders and agreeing on key objectives of the Top Team Alignment workshop
- Design the two-day intervention.
- Facilitate the two-day workshop.
- Feedback to the CEO after the workshop.

Suggested Design

- Discover what is working with the team.
- Agree on what is the collective aspiration and why it matters to each.
- Agree on the broad strategies and norms for working together.
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Here we are looking at collective alignment and effectiveness of the top team.